Simon Hirst

SOFTWARE ENGINEER - .NET / BACKEND

Southampton, UK - open to hybrid or remote | +44 7455 980143 | simonhirst@pm.me
github.com/simon-hirst | linkedin.com/in/simon-hirst-uk

PROFILE

Software engineer with seven years of commercial experience across C#/.NET, TypeScript/Node.js, Go and Java. In C#/.NET, built ASP.NET Core checkout and Stripe payment flows, REST APIs and Azure Functions for queue-based integrations, and cut a nightly job from over five hours to thirty minutes through SQL and scheduling optimisation. Three years at IBM on IBM MQ (enterprise messaging) for Kubernetes and OpenShift. Strong in debugging running systems, testability and incremental improvement of existing code; uses Claude Code and Codex CLI day to day.

CORE SKILLS

Languages	C#, SQL, TypeScript/JavaScript, Go, Java
Backend	ASP.NET Core, .NET, Azure Functions, REST APIs, Node.js, Express
Messaging / cache	IBM MQ, RabbitMQ, Redis
Platform	Docker, Kubernetes, OpenShift, Helm, Azure, GitHub Actions
Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, alerting, structured logging, tracing
Testing	xUnit, Jest, Playwright
Web / real-time	React, Next.js, WebSockets, WebRTC, Server-Sent Events
AI-assisted dev	Claude Code, Codex CLI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Engineer - Streaming infrastructure, Remote Apr 2026 - present

- Built a Node.js live-streaming stack using WebRTC, obs-websocket, MediaMTX and SRTLA, with automatic failover, real-time telemetry/audio and 146 automated tests.

Cirium - Software Engineer, Southampton (hybrid) Nov 2025 - Apr 2026

- Shipped a production fix to JFK flight-cancellation handling affecting over 100 flights per day, validating the result with SQL in staging and production.
- Diagnosed late and out-of-order flight messages across three connectors using logs, SQL and monitoring.
- Triaged GitHub Advanced Security alerts across two services; four closures approved by the security team.

Freelance Software Engineer - Remote Aug 2024 - Nov 2025

- Built .NET/Node.js web applications with Next.js, webhooks, automated tests, CI and telemetry; also developed a TypeScript/WebGL2 audio visualisation engine.

IBM - Software Engineer, Remote Jul 2021 - Jul 2024

- Maintained IBM MQ (enterprise messaging) deployment configuration, Helm charts and manifests across Kubernetes and OpenShift for over ten supported environments.
- Wrote Go tooling to validate cluster prerequisites before installation, reducing failed installations caused by environment misconfiguration.
- Added Prometheus metrics and Grafana dashboards used by four teams, and led investigations spanning high availability, storage, networking, upgrades and disaster recovery.

Dootrix - Software Engineer, Remote Mar 2020 - Jul 2021

- Built .NET and React onboarding and account-management flows including email verification, password reset and multi-factor authentication.
- Developed REST APIs and Azure Functions for CRM and queue-based integrations, with xUnit, Jest and Playwright coverage plus logging and tracing.

Zupa - Software Engineer, Southampton Sep 2019 - Mar 2020

- Cut a nightly reconciliation and notification job from over five hours to thirty minutes by optimising SQL queries and background job scheduling, and added operational alerting around it.
- Developed ASP.NET Core checkout and Stripe payment flows with validation, idempotency and safe retry handling.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science (2:1) - University of Liverpool, first-class dissertation